

# INFLATEGATE

Blue denotes PPT slide

Brown denotes instructions to technician

**(BEGIN SERMON WITH NEWS CLIP OF THE NEW ENGLAND DEFLATE-GATE CONTROVERSY)**

**(PLACE A COMPLETELY DEFLATED FOOTBALL AND A COMPLETELY INFLATED FOOTBALL ON THE TABLE NEXT TO PODIUM – ALSO HAVE AIR PUMP AVAILABLE)**

Life has a way of knocking the air out of us...  
Battering ram of life...

A football takes a beating:

- Thrown...
- Kicked...
- Punched...
- Spiked...
- Squeezed...
- Fallen on...

The reason a football can take the abuse it does and not loose air pressure is because the pressure inside is greater than the abuse from the outside. If we have Christ we are more than adequate to take on the challenges life will throw at us.

*Romans 8:35-39 (NLT) “Can anything ever separate us from Christ’s love? Does it mean he no longer loves us if we have trouble or calamity, or are persecuted, or hungry, or destitute, or in danger, or threatened with death? <sup>36</sup> (As the Scriptures say, “For your sake we are killed every day; we are being slaughtered like sheep.”) <sup>37</sup> No, despite all these things, overwhelming victory is ours through Christ, who loved us. <sup>38</sup> And I am convinced that nothing can ever separate us from God’s love. Neither death nor life, neither angels nor demons, neither our fears for today nor our worries about tomorrow—not even the powers of hell can separate us from God’s love. <sup>39</sup> No power in the sky above or in the earth below—indeed, nothing in all creation will ever be able to separate us from the love of God that is revealed in Christ Jesus our Lord.”*

The way God sees things and the way we see things are very different. God's thoughts and our thoughts are more times than not on two different wavelengths:

- God functions in reality, we operate in perception....
- God functions in actuality, we operate in observation...
- God functions in truth, we operate by fact...
- God functions in faith, we walk by sight...

When we see things differently than God sees them we often speak out of what we see rather than what we are supposed to know. This kind of living causes us to say one thing while God is saying something completely different, which leads to a deflated existence.

Prayer and faith carry with them the ability to move what we need, from the Heavenly realm to the natural realm. *“Life and death is in the power of the tongue.”*

I want us to look at some things that deflate us, and what God wants to do to inflate us.

**(AS I READ EACH SCRIPTURE IN THE NEXT SEGMENTS HAVE CAMERA ON THE DEFLATED FOOTBALL AND PROJECT ONTO SCREENS – I WILL INFLATE THE FOOTBALL AS I READ THE SCRIPTURE)**

Difficulty deflates us and we tend to use words like “*It is impossible.*” God wants to inflate us by helping us to understand... **(CAMERA ON FOOTBALL)** “*What is impossible from a human perspective is possible with God.*” (Luke 18:27 NLT) “*God has not given us a spirit of fear and timidity, but of power, love, and self-discipline.*” (2 Timothy 1:7 NLT)

Weariness tends to deflate us, but God wants to inflate us with His constant presence... **(CAMERA ON FOOTBALL)** “*Come to me, all of you who are weary and carry heavy burdens, and I will give you rest.*”<sup>29</sup> Take my

*yoke upon you. Let me teach you, because I am humble and gentle, and you will find rest for your souls. <sup>30</sup> For my yoke fits perfectly, and the burden I give you is light.” (Matthew 28:11-30 NLT)*

Relationships can deflate us, but God desires to inflate us by allowing us to see others through the same lens He uses to see us... **(CAMERA ON FOOTBALL)** *“For God so loved the world that he gave his only Son, so that everyone who believes in him will not perish but have eternal life.” (John 3:16 NLT) “I am giving you a new commandment: Love each other. Just as I have loved you, you should love each other. <sup>35</sup> Your love for one another will prove to the world that you are my disciples.” (John 13:34-35)*

Financial responsibility and difficulty can deflate us, but God wants to inflate us by letting us know... **(CAMERA ON FOOTBALL)** *“My gracious favor is all you need. My power works best in your weakness.” (2 Corinthians 12:9 NLT) “When they call on me, I will answer; I will be with them in trouble. I*

*will rescue them and honor them.” (Psalm 91:15 NLT) “God will supply all your needs from his glorious riches, which have been given to us in Christ Jesus.” (Philippians 4:19 NLT)*

Decision-making in life tends to deflate us, but God wants to inflate us by giving clear and concise direction... **(CAMERA ON FOOTBALL)** *“Trust in the LORD with all your heart; do not depend on your own understanding. <sup>6</sup> Seek his will in all you do, and he will direct your paths.” (Proverbs 3:5-6 NLT) “If you need wisdom—if you want to know what God wants you to do—ask him, and he will gladly tell you. He will not resent your asking.” (James 1:5 NLT)*

Doing the right thing when others are not reciprocating can deflate us, but God wants to inflate us by guaranteeing us His reward... **(CAMERA ON FOOTBALL)** *“Don’t get tired of doing what is good. Don’t get discouraged and give up, for we will reap a harvest of*

*blessing at the appropriate time.” (Galatians 6:9 NLT)*

Sinful behavior and failure deflates us, but God wants to inflate us by letting us know...

**(CAMERA ON FOOTBALL)** *“If we confess our sins to him, he is faithful and just to forgive us and to cleanse us from every wrong.” (John 1:9 NLT) “There is no condemnation for those who belong to Christ Jesus.” (Romans 8:1 NLT)*